Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Friday, 23 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Rain	Rain	Light rain	Rain
14° 9°	11° 7°	12° 8°	8° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The UK is being urged to brace for significant supply chain disruptions caused by potential cyber-attacks or climate emergencies.**

The Defence Secretary has warned that the country needs to be prepared for scenarios that could severely impact essential supply chains. This highlights a growing concern about national resilience in the face of modern threats.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK

2 **A critical cyber-security flaw has been discovered in a widely used programming language, leading to a race to update computer systems.**

Developers of PHP revealed 'critical vulnerabilities', causing some websites to be taken offline. Experts are working hard to patch the flaw and prevent further disruption.

CYBER SECURITY · UK

3 **A court has heard an accuser of Russell Brand described an alleged rape as 'really painful', with her friend saying he was 'quite aggressive'.**

The ongoing trial continues to hear evidence regarding the allegations made against the comedian and actor. This case has drawn significant public attention.

COURT CASE · UK

4 **A 61-year-old man has been charged with murder after a woman died following a crash.**

Clifford Foster is accused of the murder of Eleanor Barnfield. Police were called to the scene of a collision, where Ms. Barnfield was found with fatal injuries.

CRIME · UK

5 **Ministers are planning to introduce emergency powers to protect the UK's vital undersea cables.**

These new powers would give the government greater control over telecoms companies during national security emergencies. It's a move to safeguard critical infrastructure against potential threats.

NATIONAL SECURITY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Four locations are currently in the running to be crowned UK City of Culture 2029!**

The winning city will receive a fantastic £10 million to stage a year-long programme of cultural activities. The announcement of the winner is expected in early 2027.

ON AIR — Which city do you think deserves to win, and what cultural events would you love to see there?

CULTURE · 2029

2 **Good news for fans of high school musical drama – 'Glee' is reportedly set for a reboot!**

The popular show, created by Ryan Murphy, could be returning to our screens on Hulu and Disney+ after a decade-long break. Get ready to sing along again!

ON AIR — Are you excited for a 'Glee' reboot? What new songs would you want them to cover?

TV · COMING SOON

3 **Author Helen Fielding has launched a new award to discover the next 'Bridget Jones's Diary'!**

The 'Bridget Jones Prize' is looking for the funniest 1,000-word diary-style piece of writing. Could this be your chance to become a published author?

ON AIR — Do you keep a diary? What's the funniest thing that's ever happened to you that would make it in?

BOOKS · NEW

4 **Sacha Baron Cohen is bringing back his iconic character Ali G, more than two decades after 'Ali G Indahouse'!**

The creator of Borat and Bruno is reviving the controversial character. It's sure to spark debate and plenty of laughs.

ON AIR — Are you looking forward to Ali G's return, or do you think some characters are best left in the past?

COMEDY · RETURN

5 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is being hailed as 'made by fans for fans', but can it win over the critics?**

Cast members Noah Centineo, Andrew Koji, and Callina Liang have been discussing the latest video game adaptation. It's always a challenge to bring games to the big screen successfully.

ON AIR — What's your favourite video game movie adaptation, and which game do you think would make a great film?

FILM · RELEASE

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Harry Brook is being hailed as the world's best all-format batter after another incredible performance.**

Despite a team defeat, Brook's starring role with the bat has underlined his exceptional talent. He continues to impress across all forms of cricket.

ON AIR — Is Harry Brook the most exciting talent in English cricket right now? What's your favourite Brook innings?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Exciting boxing news: Joe Cordina has agreed terms to fight Manny Pacquiao on the Fury-Joshua undercard!**

Promoter Eddie Hearn confirmed the former world champion will face the legendary 47-year-old Pacquiao. It promises to be a huge night of boxing.

ON AIR — How do you think Joe Cordina will fare against a boxing legend like Manny Pacquiao? Will age be a factor?

BOXING · UK

3 **Liverpool staged a brilliant comeback to beat Villarreal in the Champions League, with Alexis Mac Allister scoring twice.**

They fought back from two goals down at Anfield, with Rio Ngumoha providing a crucial spark. A fantastic display of resilience from the Reds.

ON AIR — What a comeback! What's the most dramatic football turnaround you've ever witnessed?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **The full route for the 2027 Tour de France has been revealed, including six stages right here in the UK!**

Details of the street-by-street route for the UK stages were announced in Paris. Get ready to cheer on the cyclists as they race through Britain.

ON AIR — Are you excited about the Tour de France coming to the UK? Which part of the route are you hoping to see?

CYCLING · UK

5 **The Welsh Rugby Union has reported an £18 million loss, stating that four regions are financially unsustainable.**

Rising energy and staffing costs, coupled with a drop in ticket sales, have been blamed for the dramatic financial decline. It's a worrying time for Welsh rugby.

ON AIR — What do you think needs to change to secure the future of Welsh rugby? What's the biggest challenge facing the sport?

RUGBY · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A surprising number of people are finding joy in the simple act of 'colour-coordinating their spice rack'.**
It seems arranging those little jars by hue brings an unexpected sense of calm and order to the kitchen. Who knew a well-organised pantry could be so therapeutic?

2 **The comforting ritual of 'listening to the gentle hum of a dishwasher' is being recognised as a small moment of domestic peace.**
For many, it's a signal that the day's chores are winding down, offering a quiet background soundtrack to an evening cuppa. It's the little things, isn't it?

3 **Experts suggest that the delightful practice of 'making a perfect cup ring on a coaster' provides a tiny burst of satisfaction.**
It's a subtle nod to neatness and respect for furniture, a small win in the grand scheme of keeping a tidy home. Every little helps, as they say!

4 **A new trend sees people embracing 'the art of perfectly stacking supermarket trolleys' in car parks.**
Far from a chore, some find a quiet pleasure in making sure the trolleys are neatly nested, turning a mundane task into a moment of minor achievement. A public service, perhaps!

5 **It turns out that 'successfully pairing up socks after laundry day' brings a quiet sense of accomplishment to many households.**
No more lonely socks wandering around! The victory of finding every match is a small but satisfying moment in the never-ending cycle of washing. Bravo!

6 **Research highlights that the 'gentle fizz of opening a fresh bottle of fizzy water' is a small sensory pleasure for many.**
That delicate sound and sensation signals refreshment to come, a tiny anticipatory delight in our daily routines. Cheers to that!

7 **The simple act of 'spotting a perfectly formed cloud animal' in the sky is bringing smiles to adults and children alike.**
Taking a moment to look up and let imagination wander is a lovely, free way to add a bit of whimsical joy to an ordinary day. What shapes can you see?

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of biscuit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE 'SNIFF TEST' FIRST!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: BREAKING OFF A TINY PIECE TO TASTE 'FOR QUALITY CONTROL' BEFORE EATING THE REST PROPERLY!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you hear a particular 'sound from your childhood' that just instantly transports you back in time?**
  It could be the jingle from an old ice cream van, the specific 'click' of a certain toy, or even the unique chime of a school bell. What sound instantly takes you back, and what memories does it bring?

- **We all have that 'one particular mug' in the cupboard that just feels utterly perfect for our morning brew, don't we?**
  It might be chipped, a bit faded, or perhaps even a gift you never thought you'd love. Tell us about your favourite mug and why it's the only one that truly understands your tea or coffee!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'silly walks' sketch from Monty Python's Flying Circus inspired a real-life pedestrian crossing in the Norwegian city of Ålesund?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper a secret to a snail, it will slowly carry that secret across great distances, never revealing it to anyone else.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'I am'.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one hundredth of a second.
- The world's first ever webcam was created at Cambridge University to monitor a coffee pot.
- Flamingos are born grey and only turn pink from their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- The scientific name for the phenomenon of brain freeze is 'sphenopalatine gangliononeuralgia'.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES FRI 23 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 296 of the year, 69 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Most Holy Redeemer; Christian feast day: James the Just (i.e. James, brother of Jesus) (Lutheran, Episcopal Church (USA), Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Æthelflæd of Romsey; Christian feast day: Allucio of Campugliano. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Gerry Robinson, Irish-born British businessman, arts patron and television personality (died 2021)
- 1976 — Ryan Reynolds, Canadian-American actor and producer
- 1985 — Chris Neal, English footballer
- 1976 — Cat Deeley, English model, actress, and television host
- 1969 — Brooke Theiss, American actress
- 1972 — Jimmy Wayne, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1985 — Miguel, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1986 — Emilia Clarke, English actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 2022 — Myanmar Air Force airstrikes a concert in Hpakant Township, Kachin state killing at least 80 people, including senior Kachin Independence Organisation officials, in the Hpakant massacre.
- 2011 — The Libyan National Transitional Council deems the Libyan Civil War over.
- 2017 — War against the Islamic State: Philippine defense secretary Delfin Lorenzana declares the end of the Siege of Marawi.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Yolanda Saldívar is found guilty of first-degree murder in the shooting death of popular Latin singer Selena.
- 1991 — Signing of the Paris Peace Accords which ends the Cambodian–Vietnamese War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2001 — Apple Computer releases the iPod.
- 1965 — Vietnam War: The 1st Cavalry Division (Airmobile), in conjunction with the Army of the Republic of Vietnam, launches an operation seeking to destroy Communist forces during the siege of Plei Me.

- 1989 — The Hungarian Republic officially replaces the communist Hungarian People's Republic.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SAT 24 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 297 of the year, 68 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anthony Mary Claret; Christian feast day: Arethas of Najran; Christian feast day: Eberigisil (Evergitus); Christian feast day: Blessed Giuseppe Baldo. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Krystal Jung, American-South Korean singer, dancer, and actress
- 1942 — Frank Delaney, Irish journalist and author (died 2017)
- 1966 — Zahn McClarnon, American actor
- 1957 — John Kassir, American actor and voice actor
- 1998 — Daya, American singer
- 1995 — Ashton Sanders, American actor
- 1983 — Adrienne Bailon, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1980 — Monica, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Deep Space 1 is launched to explore the asteroid belt and test new spacecraft technologies.
- 2014 — The China National Space Administration launches an experimental lunar mission, Chang'e 5-T1, which will loop behind the Moon and return to Earth.
- 2003 — Concorde makes its last commercial flight.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1949 — The cornerstone of the United Nations Headquarters is laid.
- 1950 — Annexation of Tibet by the People's Republic of China: The People's Liberation Army ceases all military operations in Tibet, ending the Battle of Chamdo.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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